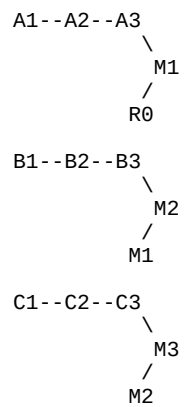


filter-repo + subtree vs merge + read-tree

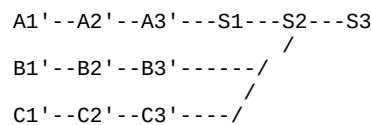
Comparison for combining repositories A, B, and C into a monorepo while preserving history and supporting future updates.

Commit Graph - merge + read-tree



Produces multiple merge commits and a more complex graph.

Commit Graph - filter-repo + subtree



Cleaner monorepo structure using subtree imports.

History Preservation

merge+read-tree preserves original commit SHAs. filter-repo rewrites SHAs but preserves author, date, and commit message.

Future Updates

merge+read-tree requires custom update scripts and can fail with .gitattributes overlap issues. subtree supports simple updates using git subtree pull.

Maintenance

merge+read-tree requires ongoing maintenance of custom scripts. filter-repo + subtree uses standard Git workflows.

Scorecard

Category	merge+read-tree	filter-repo+subtree
Initial migration	7/10	9/10
Commit graph	5/10	9/10
History preservation	10/10	8/10
Future updates	3/10	10/10

Maintenance	3/10	9/10
Reliability	5/10	9/10

Recommendation

For repositories that continue receiving commits and require future synchronization, filter-repo + subtree is usually the cleaner and more maintainable approach.